

iPhone 09?

Apple iPhone 2009 comes on 17 July, OLED display on board

More power, less juice

Marvell's new Tavor processors feature an HSDPA baseband processor and an applications processor on a single chip

volume and handsfree unit are excellent. Priced at Rs. 34,990, the Bold 9000 isn't cheap, but it's a worthy device for the corporate — classy looking, powerful, very usable and feature-rich.

Blackberry Curve 8900

The Blackberry Curve 8900 is slightly smaller than the Bold 9000 and features the same smooth finish; but a bit more chrome on the front. The back is similar to the Blackberry Storm 9500 and is brushed black aluminium. The screen is slightly smaller than the Bold's but offers a slightly higher resolution. The menu and call buttons are similar to the Bold 9000 but slightly smaller, owing to the phone's compact dimensions. The 3.5-mm headset jack is now on the right side instead of the left like the Bold 9000 and the volume button below that is really usable; its not as flat as the button on the Bold 9000 and this is a good thing for intuitiveness. The trackball is black on this phone — we preferred the milky white that is so iconic to the Blackberry. The QWERTY keypad is very well laid out but seems a little less usable than the Bold 9000's keypad. This is due to the keypad gap and bevelling. Some might find the keypad on the Curve 8900 to be better than its bulkier sibling and mostly these people will have larger

fingers and the gap in the keypad will suit their fingers more. It's a close call either way, but we prefer the Bold 9000's slightly larger, less spaced out keys. The Curve 8900 is fast and responsive.

Next, on to our call and signal clarity tests, and we were pretty surprised when voice clarity did not drop when moving from zone 1 to zone 2. Even in the middle of zone 2, we could still get the same clarity as before. This proves the mettle of the antenna and to be quite honest this phone probably has the best antenna in the test, although it cannot outpace the Nokia N95 8 G's performance in zone 1. The handsfree unit is also clear and crisp. With GPS support, a decent 3.2 megapixel camera and a good keypad; this phone is priced very competitively at Rs. 27,990. If you're hunting for a good Blackberry phone and the Bold 9000 is a little too pricey go ahead and buy this — it'll more than satisfy.

In conclusion

A lot of phones have very similar feature sets. It seems manufacturers are putting everything they can possibly load into their high-end options — GPS, flash storage, powerful cameras, good PMP capabilities, loads of multimedia and shortcut button and larger displays capable of a wider colour gamut. A few phones stood out from the rest. Motorola's Moto RAZR V8 would be our pick for an urbane user looking for something trendy and chic. For users looking for a

real smartphone with strong multimedia genes and superb all round performance its hard to get any better than Nokia's N96 and N95 8 GB. Such devices have features enough to last you a while and you'll seldom feel the need for an upgrade. One phone that also stood out for its equal orientation towards business and multimedia segments was the Sony Ericsson Xperia X1 — this handset is perhaps held back by the platform its based on, as WM is not known to be multimedia friendly. If you really want the biggest touch screen around the HTC Touch HD is costly but a superb phone with very good all round performance.

For corporate users on a budget we strongly recommend the Nokia E71 — its a big phone with a small price tag and is superbly built. The Blackberry Bold 9000 and Curve 8900 are the best business handsets for corporates willing to spend, Nokia's E75 also bears a mention with its features and performance, but one cannot match the keypads that Blackberry's have and this scores strongly for business users. The fact that Blackberry too is busy adding multimedia features to their handsets speaks volumes for their seriousness to break out of the mould of being "only for business users".

The current recessionary trend notwithstanding, manufacturers are not shying away from offering feature rich, flagship offerings with rocketing price tags.

Obviously there is a certain minimum cost associated with technology; that cannot be done away with, but its emboldening as well as heartening to see such phones actually being released, and even more interesting is the accompanying hype they generate. There are rumours of Apple creating a successor to the iPhone 3G called the iPhone 2009, but details other than support for video recording and

a faster processor remain sketchy. Many thought of Nokia's N97 as a concept phone, but it's actually been released, filled to the brim with features. We'll save being impressed until we get to review it

later this year.

The HTC Touch Pro 2 is another phone worth waiting for, with an amalgamation of the best elements of the Touch HD and the Touch Pro. Sony Ericsson's Xperia X2 is another phone that remains a mystery and it's anybody's guess whether this one will be based on WM 6.5 or feature a Symbian-powered platform. Their Idou has already been announced and with a camera that supports a mind-boggling 12-megapixels; it may well be the next camera phone to buy.

We're already in the age of converged handsets, but those features are getting better by the month. Not that we'll ever run out of things to nitpick about, but each year this test is becoming more fun and more challenging as these devices slowly push the boundaries of our expectancies outwards. **[1]**

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Blackberry Curve 8900

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Mobile Phone Comparison Test

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Apple	Apple India Pvt Ltd	-	Contact service providers	www.apple.co.in
ASUS	ASUS Technology Pvt. Ltd.	media_india@asus.com	+91-22-67668800	www.asus.in
Blackberry	BlackBerry	-	Contact service providers	www.blackberry.com
HTC	Jaina Marketing	deepak@jainaindia.com	+91-11-46604660	www.htc.com/in
LG	LG Electronics India Pvt. Ltd.	VivekSingh@lgindia.com	120-2560900/40	www.lgindia.com
Motorola	Motorola India	-	1-800-111-211	www.motorola.com/in
Nokia	Nokia India Pvt. Ltd	-	+91-11-30303838	www.nokia.com
Samsung	Samsung India	sarfaraz.b@samsung.com	+91-11-41511234	in.samsungmobile.com
Sony Ericsson	Sony Ericsson	-	1-800-111-800	www.sonyericsson.com